

Program Development & Evaluation

Learner guide | SWP-015 | School of Community & Macro Practice

This guide supports a three-part learning sequence for Program Development & Evaluation. By the end of the course, you should be able to design a feasible community programme and measure whether it works.

Practice notice: Apply the law, organisational policy, supervision requirements, and approved referral pathways that govern your setting. This material supports learning and does not replace urgent safeguarding, clinical, or legal procedures.

Learning objectives

- Design a feasible community programme and measure whether it works.
- Apply the key ideas from Programme design.
- Apply the key ideas from Implementation planning.
- Apply the key ideas from Monitoring and evaluation.

Course structure

Module	Focus	Suggested study time
1. Programme design	needs-to-goals chain, theory of change, target groups, and feasibility	10 to 15 minutes
2. Implementation planning	activities, budget assumptions, partnerships, risk management, and inclusion	10 to 15 minutes
3. Monitoring and evaluation	indicators, baseline, data collection, learning loops, and reporting	10 to 15 minutes

Module 1 Programme design

This module focuses on needs-to-goals chain, theory of change, target groups, and feasibility. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Needs-to-goals chain
- Theory of change
- Target groups
- Feasibility

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of programme design in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of needs-to-goals chain, theory of change, target groups, and feasibility. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through programme design safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Module 2 Implementation planning

This module focuses on activities, budget assumptions, partnerships, risk management, and inclusion. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Activities
- Budget assumptions
- Partnerships
- Risk management
- Inclusion

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of implementation planning in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of activities, budget assumptions, partnerships, risk management, and inclusion. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through implementation planning safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Module 3 Monitoring and evaluation

This module focuses on indicators, baseline, data collection, learning loops, and reporting. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Indicators
- Baseline
- Data collection
- Learning loops
- Reporting

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of monitoring and evaluation in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of indicators, baseline, data collection, learning loops, and reporting. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through monitoring and evaluation safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Course activity

Use the accompanying worksheet to apply the course sequence to a short case. Your completed activity should show what you noticed, the action you would take within your role, and what you would escalate or verify locally.

Assessment preparation

- Review the distinction between: theory of change.
- Review the distinction between: outputs/outcomes.
- Review the distinction between: indicators.
- Review the distinction between: evaluation ethics.

References and local adaptation

- SWEEP Academy Course Content Outlines, production blueprint for this course.
- The current legislation, professional standards, safeguarding procedures, and referral directories for the delivery jurisdiction.
- The learner's employer or placement policy, supervision arrangements, and documentation standards.